



FAITH FOUNDATIONS STUDY SERIES

Christian Bible Learning Workbook

A Teen & Young Adult Guide to Reading, Understanding, and Living the Bible

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Ages 13-19 - Homeschool & Youth Groups

Personal Study - Small Groups - Reproducible for one household or class

HOW TO USE THIS STUDY

Getting the Most From This Workbook

This workbook is built for students ages 13 to 19 who want more than Sunday-school answers. Over six units you will learn how the Bible is put together, how to read it for yourself, and how to move from information to transformation. Each unit includes a devotional, an inductive study you drive, a word study, journaling, and either a discussion or a real-world challenge.

2 TIMOTHY 3:16

"All Scripture is God-breathed and is useful for teaching, rebuking, correcting and training in righteousness."

A Few Suggestions

- ☐ Find a consistent time and place. Even 15 focused minutes beats an hour you never start.
- ☐ Keep a pen in hand. Writing your answers turns reading into real thinking.
- ☐ Read each passage in your own Bible too, and note the version differences.
- ☐ Be honest in the reflection and journal sections - no one is grading you.
- ☐ If you meet with a group, come having already written your answers.
- ☐ Pray before you begin. Ask God to teach you, not just inform you.

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UNIT 1

Why the Bible Matters

"Your word is a lamp for my feet, a light on my path." - Psalm 119:105

Unit Overview

Before we open the Bible, we ask what it even is and why anyone should build a life on it. This unit frames Scripture as God's self-revelation, not a rulebook.

DEVOTIONAL

More Than a Book

You have probably owned a Bible longer than you have actually read one. This unit is about changing that.

HEBREWS 4:12

"The word of God is alive and active, sharper than any double-edged sword."

Notice the verse does not say the Bible was alive when it was written; it says it is alive now. Scripture reads you as much as you read it.

Many teens quit the Bible because they treat it like a textbook to finish. It is better understood as a conversation with the God who wrote it and is still speaking through it.

Reflect

1. What has your relationship with the Bible been like so far - honestly?

2. What would change in your week if you believed God actually speaks through these words?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, make your word alive to me. Give me hunger for it and eyes to understand.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

The Two Foundations

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

MATTHEW 7:24-27

"Therefore everyone who hears these words of mine and puts them into practice is like a wise man who built his house on the rock. The rain came down, the streams rose, and the winds blew and beat against that house; yet it did not fall, because it had its foundation on the rock. But everyone who hears these words of mine and does not put them into practice is like a foolish man who built his house on sand."

Observation - What does it say?

1. What do both builders have in common?

2. What is the single difference between them?

3. What do the storms represent in a real teenager's life?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

The Two Foundations

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why does Jesus tie wisdom to doing and not just hearing?

2. What does building on sand look like for someone your age today?

Application - What will I do?

1. Where in your life are you currently hearing but not doing?

2. What is one area you can start building on rock this week?

WORD STUDY

Truth

MEANING

Reality as God defines it - not merely accurate facts, but what is trustworthy, faithful, and real. In John, Jesus calls himself the Truth.

Where It Appears**JOHN 8:32**

"Then you will know the truth, and the truth will set you free."

JOHN 17:17

"Sanctify them by the truth; your word is truth."

Dig Deeper

1. Our culture says truth is whatever you personally feel. How does the Bible challenge that?

2. How can truth be freeing rather than limiting?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Where I'm Starting

Describe your current spiritual life in a few honest sentences.

What do you hope is different by the end of this workbook?

What is one question about God or the Bible you have never gotten a real answer to?

FAITH & WORLDVIEW

Can We Trust the Bible?

THE QUESTION

Is the Bible reliable, or was it just made up and edited over time?

Think It Through**Manuscript evidence**

There are more early copies of the New Testament than of any other ancient document, and they agree with remarkable consistency.

Honest reporting

The Bible records the failures of its own heroes - an odd choice for a fabricated legend meant to promote them.

Unity

Written by dozens of authors across roughly 1,500 years, it tells one connected story pointing to Christ.

Your Response

1. Which of these points is most convincing to you, and why?

2. What objection do you still have - and who could help you explore it?

UNIT 2

How the Bible Is Organized

"Do your best to present yourself to God as one who correctly handles the word of truth." - 2 Timothy 2:15

Unit Overview

You cannot navigate a library you do not understand. This unit maps the 66 books, the two testaments, and the main genres so reading stops feeling random.

DEVOTIONAL

Learning the Map

Imagine trying to use a phone with no home screen. That is what the Bible feels like until you learn its layout.

2 TIMOTHY 2:15

"Do your best to present yourself to God as one approved, a worker who correctly handles the word of truth."

The Bible is a library of 66 books: history, law, poetry, prophecy, biography, and letters. Reading a psalm the way you read a legal contract will confuse you.

Knowing the genre of what you are reading is the first step to reading it well.

Reflect

1. Which parts of the Bible have you found most confusing, and could genre be part of why?

2. How might reading Proverbs differently from Romans help you?

PRAYER PROMPT

Lord, give me patience to learn how your word is put together.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

A Guide to Understanding

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

NEHEMIAH 8:5-8

"Ezra opened the book. All the people could see him because he was standing above them; and as he opened it, the people all stood up. The Levites instructed the people in the Law while the people were standing there. They read from the Book of the Law of God, making it clear and giving the meaning so that the people understood what was being read."

Observation - What does it say?

1. What did the people do when the book was opened?

2. What did the Levites add to the reading?

3. What was the goal of all this effort?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

A Guide to Understanding

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why is explanation, not just reading, sometimes necessary?

2. What does this teach about studying with others?

Application - What will I do?

1. Who helps you understand the Bible? Who could you ask?

2. What tool (study Bible, app, mentor) will you start using?

WORD STUDY

Testament

MEANING

A covenant or binding agreement. The Old Testament records God's covenant with Israel; the New Testament, the new covenant established through Jesus.

Where It Appears**LUKE 22:20**

"This cup is the new covenant in my blood, which is poured out for you."

2 CORINTHIANS 3:6

"He has made us competent as ministers of a new covenant."

Dig Deeper

1. What is 'new' about the new covenant compared to the old?

2. How does seeing the Bible as one covenant story change how you read it?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

My Reading Plan

Which book of the Bible will you read first, and why?

What time of day realistically works for you to read?

What obstacles usually stop you, and how will you handle them this time?

SMALL GROUP DISCUSSION

Talk It Over

Share openly. The goal is not to sound spiritual but to be honest.

1. What surprised you about how the Bible is organized?

2. Which genre are you most drawn to - story, poetry, letters - and why?

3. How can this group help each other actually keep reading?

UNIT 3

Reading for Yourself

"Like newborn babies, crave pure spiritual milk, so that by it you may grow up in your salvation." - 1 Peter 2:2

Unit Overview

This unit teaches a simple, repeatable method: observe, interpret, apply. Once you own it, you can study any passage without depending on someone else.

DEVOTIONAL

Feeding Yourself

There is a difference between being fed and learning to cook. This unit hands you the tools.

1 PETER 2:2

"Like newborn babies, crave pure spiritual milk, so that by it you may grow up in your salvation."

Spiritual growth is not automatic; it is fueled. Peter compares Scripture to milk that a growing person craves.

The aim is not to stay dependent on a pastor or parent to feed you, but to learn to feed yourself for a lifetime.

Reflect

1. Are you currently craving God's word, tolerating it, or avoiding it?

2. What would help you develop an appetite for Scripture?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, grow in me a real hunger for your word.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

The Bereans' Example

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

ACTS 17:11

"Now the Berean Jews were of more noble character than those in Thessalonica, for they received the message with great eagerness and examined the Scriptures every day to see if what Paul said was true."

Observation - What does it say?

1. What two things made the Bereans 'noble'?

2. How often did they examine Scripture?

3. What were they checking?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

The Bereans' Example

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why is it healthy to check even good teaching against the Bible?

2. What is the balance between eagerness and examination?

Application - What will I do?

1. How will you personally examine what you are taught?

2. What does 'daily' realistically look like for you?

WORD STUDY

Meditate

MEANING

In Scripture, to meditate is to chew on and repeat God's word until it shapes your thinking - not to empty your mind, but to fill it.

Where It Appears**PSALM 1:1-2**

"Blessed is the one whose delight is in the law of the Lord, and who meditates on his law day and night."

JOSHUA 1:8

"Keep this Book of the Law always on your lips; meditate on it day and night."

Dig Deeper

1. How is biblical meditation different from popular ideas of meditation?

2. What is one verse you could 'chew on' this week?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Practicing the Method

Pick any verse. Write what you observe (what it says).

Now write what you think it means and why.

Finally, write one specific way you will apply it.

APPLICATION CHALLENGE

Try It for a Week

Knowledge you never use fades fast. Put this unit's method into practice.

This Week's Challenges

- ☐ Read one chapter of a Gospel each day for five days.
- ☐ Write one observation, one meaning, and one application each day.
- ☐ Share one thing you learned with someone else.
- ☐ Pray through one passage instead of just reading it.

What happened when you tried?

UNIT 4

The Big Story

"You study the Scriptures... These are the very Scriptures that testify about me." -
John 5:39

Unit Overview

The Bible is not disconnected lessons; it is one story in four movements - Creation, Fall, Redemption, Restoration - all centered on Jesus.

DEVOTIONAL

One Story, Not Sixty-Six

Most people read the Bible like a book of quotes. It is actually one story going somewhere.

LUKE 24:27

"And beginning with Moses and all the Prophets, he explained to them what was said in all the Scriptures concerning himself."

On the road to Emmaus, Jesus showed that the whole Old Testament was pointing to him. The Bible has a main character, and it is not you.

Creation, Fall, Redemption, Restoration: knowing this arc keeps individual verses from feeling random.

Reflect

1. Have you tended to read the Bible as being mainly about you or mainly about God?

2. How does seeing Jesus as the center change a familiar story for you?

PRAYER PROMPT

Jesus, help me see you on every page.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

The Story Begins Again

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

GENESIS 3:8-15

"Then the man and his wife heard the sound of the Lord God as he was walking in the garden in the cool of the day, and they hid from the Lord God among the trees. But the Lord God called to the man, 'Where are you?' ... And I will put enmity between you and the woman, and between your offspring and hers; he will crush your head, and you will strike his heel."

Observation - What does it say?

1. What do the man and woman do when they hear God?

2. What is God's first question to them?

3. What promise is hidden in verse 15?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

The Story Begins Again

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why does God ask 'Where are you?' if he already knows?

2. How is verse 15 the first hint of the gospel?

Application - What will I do?

1. Where do you tend to hide from God?

2. How does knowing the story ends in rescue change your fear?

WORD STUDY

Redemption

MEANING

To buy back or set free by paying a price. The Bible describes salvation as God redeeming people from sin and death at the cost of Christ.

Where It Appears**EPHESIANS 1:7**

"In him we have redemption through his blood, the forgiveness of sins."

1 CORINTHIANS 6:20

"You were bought at a price. Therefore honor God with your bodies."

Dig Deeper

1. What price was paid for your redemption?

2. If you were 'bought at a price,' how does that change how you see your worth?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Finding My Place in the Story

Which part of the story - Creation, Fall, Redemption, Restoration - do you most need to hear right now?

Where do you see brokenness (the Fall) in your own world?

What does the promise of Restoration give you hope for?

FAITH & WORLDVIEW

Why Is There Suffering?

THE QUESTION

If God is good and powerful, why does he allow pain and evil?

Think It Through**The Fall**

The Bible traces suffering to a real break between humanity and God, not to God's cruelty.

A God who enters it

Christianity is unique in claiming God himself suffered on the cross rather than staying distant from pain.

A promised end

Restoration means suffering is temporary, not the final word.

Your Response

1. How is the Christian answer to suffering different from just 'everything happens for a reason'?

2. What suffering in your life do you most want to bring honestly to God?

UNIT 5

From Knowing to Living

"Do not merely listen to the word... Do what it says." - James 1:22

Unit Overview

Information that never becomes action puffs up rather than builds up. This unit is about obedience, character, and letting Scripture reshape daily choices.

DEVOTIONAL

The Danger of Just Knowing

It is possible to know a lot about the Bible and still not follow Jesus. This unit closes that gap.

JAMES 1:22

"Do not merely listen to the word, and so deceive yourselves. Do what it says."

James warns that hearing without doing is a form of self-deception - we feel spiritual without being changed.

The goal of Bible study was never a full head; it was a transformed life.

Reflect

1. Where might you be deceiving yourself - knowing truth you are not living?

2. What is one truth you already know that you need to start obeying?

PRAYER PROMPT

Lord, close the gap between what I know and how I live.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

Doers of the Word

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

JAMES 1:22-25

"Do not merely listen to the word, and so deceive yourselves. Do what it says. Anyone who listens to the word but does not do what it says is like someone who looks at his face in a mirror and, after looking at himself, goes away and immediately forgets what he looks like. But whoever looks intently into the perfect law that gives freedom, and continues in it - not forgetting what they have heard, but doing it - they will be blessed in what they do."

Observation - What does it say?

1. What is the person with the mirror like?

2. What does the blessed person do differently?

3. What is promised to the doer?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

Doers of the Word

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why does James compare the word to a mirror?

2. What does it mean that God's law 'gives freedom'?

Application - What will I do?

1. What is one thing you 'saw in the mirror' recently and forgot?

2. How will you 'continue in it' this week?

WORD STUDY

Sanctification

MEANING

The lifelong process by which God makes a believer more like Jesus. Not earning salvation, but growing in it.

Where It Appears**1 THESSALONIANS 4:3**

"It is God's will that you should be sanctified."

PHILIPPIANS 1:6

"Being confident of this, that he who began a good work in you will carry it on to completion."

Dig Deeper

1. Why is it freeing that growth is a process, not instant perfection?

2. Where have you seen God change you over the past year?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

A Life That Matches

Where is there a gap between what you believe and how you actually live?

What habit would you like God to help you build?

What habit would you like God to help you break?

APPLICATION CHALLENGE

Obedience Experiment

Pick real, measurable steps. Vague goals produce vague lives.

This Week's Challenges

- ☐ Obey one clear command of Scripture this week that you have been avoiding.
- ☐ Apologize to someone you have wronged.
- ☐ Replace 30 minutes of screen time with reading or prayer.
- ☐ Do a good deed no one will ever know about.

What happened when you tried?

UNIT 6

Building a Lasting Faith

"Continue in what you have learned and have become convinced of." - 2 Timothy 3:14

Unit Overview

Many walk away from faith in their late teens. This unit prepares you to own your beliefs, handle doubt, and keep growing when no one is making you.

DEVOTIONAL

A Faith That's Yours

Someday no one will drag you to church or hand you this workbook. Will your faith survive that?

2 TIMOTHY 3:14

"Continue in what you have learned and have become convinced of, because you know those from whom you learned it."

Paul tells Timothy to continue - faith is not a moment but a direction you keep walking.

A borrowed faith cracks under pressure; a personally examined faith holds. Doubts are not the enemy of faith; unexamined doubts are.

Reflect

1. Is your faith currently more inherited or more owned? Be honest.

2. What would help you become 'convinced' rather than just compliant?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, make my faith my own, deep enough to hold under pressure.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

Standing Firm

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

EPHESIANS 6:10-13

"Finally, be strong in the Lord and in his mighty power. Put on the full armor of God, so that you can take your stand against the devil's schemes. For our struggle is not against flesh and blood, but against the rulers, against the authorities, against the powers of this dark world. Therefore put on the full armor of God, so that when the day of evil comes, you may be able to stand your ground."

Observation - What does it say?

1. Whose power are we told to be strong in?

2. Who is the real struggle against?

3. What is the repeated goal of the armor?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

Standing Firm

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why does it matter that the strength is God's, not ours?

2. What 'schemes' target students your age specifically?

Application - What will I do?

1. Which piece of armor do you most need right now?

2. How will you 'stand your ground' this month?

WORD STUDY

Perseverance

MEANING

Steadfast endurance - continuing to trust and obey God through difficulty, doubt, and time.

Where It Appears**HEBREWS 12:1-2**

"Let us run with perseverance the race marked out for us, fixing our eyes on Jesus."

JAMES 1:12

"Blessed is the one who perseveres under trial."

Dig Deeper

1. What is the difference between perseverance and just gritting your teeth?

2. Who do you know that has persevered in faith, and what can you learn from them?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

The Road Ahead

What is one belief you want to understand more deeply?

What doubt do you need to stop hiding and start exploring?

Who will you ask to walk with you in your faith going forward?

SMALL GROUP DISCUSSION

Commissioned

This is the last discussion of the book. Talk about the road ahead, not just today.

1. What is the biggest thing you are taking away from this study?

2. What is your plan to keep growing after this workbook ends?

3. How can this group keep each other accountable in the months ahead?

MEMORY & MEDITATION

Hide This Word in Your Heart

2 TIMOTHY 3:16**"2 Timothy 3:16"**

Context

Look back over the verses you studied in this book.

Why It Matters

Scripture memorized becomes a resource the Holy Spirit can bring to mind in real moments of decision, temptation, doubt, and encouragement.

Write It From Memory

LIVE IT OUT THIS WEEK

Choose one verse from this book to carry with you all week.

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Memory Verse Review

Write out from memory: 2 Timothy 3:16

Write out from memory: Psalm 119:105

Write out from memory: Hebrews 4:12

Write out from memory: James 1:22

Write out from memory: 1 Peter 2:2

SELF-ASSESSMENT

Spiritual Check-In

Rate each statement honestly. This is between you and God - there are no wrong answers, only honest starting points.

1 = rarely 5 = consistently

I make time to read the Bible on my own.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I pray about real things in my life, not just at meals.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I can explain what I believe and why.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I treat people the way Jesus would.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I invite God into my decisions before I make them.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I am honest even when it costs me.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I serve others without expecting anything back.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I go to God first when I am anxious or afraid.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Final Reflection

What is the most important thing God taught you through this study?

How is your relationship with the Bible different now than when you started?

Write a short prayer committing to keep reading and following God.

NOTES

Study Notes

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